OBJECTS OF DESIRE

FOOD & DRINK



## RICK'S AT THE TAJ MAHAL HOTEL, NEW DELHI

**Seven Cocktails. Two Months. Only Four Survive.**

Rick's has never been an ordinary bar. Inspired by the timeless allure of Casablanca and named in honour of the film's legendary protagonist, this season, Rick's raises the stakes in a manner entirely befitting its reputation. Seven cocktails have been created—each with its own personality; its own story; its own irreplaceable character. But here is the provocation: only four will earn a permanent place on the menu. And that decision rests entirely with the guests who raise a glass.

The mechanics of participation are themselves a considered experience. Each guest receives a set of premium Rick's signature chits—weighted, intentional, designed for the moment—to be placed in sleek glass vessels at the bar. A live digital leaderboard tracks the momentum of each cocktail's campaign in real time. Conversations spark. Unexpected allegiances form. The bar—most social of all dining spaces—becomes more charged, more alive; more deliberately participatory. For two months, the menu is not fixed. It is debated, tasted, and determined by those who know.

Rick's bartenders offer guests a guided understanding of each creation's provenance, technique, and character before the vote is cast. It is Rick's at its most experimental. With a seductive combination of its Casablanca heritage and contemporary mixology, jury duty was never this inviting. Come for all seven and vote with conviction. Remember, your vote decides the mandate and the menu.




## NIKKA WHISKY, JAPAN

**Taketsuru Pure Malt Arrives in India—a first for the country!**

If single malts are the soloist, then Masataka Taketsuru—the man who brought Scotch whisky knowledge back to Japan in the 1920s—always bet on an orchestra. His philosophy lives on in the Nikka Taketsuru Pure Malt, a vatted expression that marries whisky from the Yoichi and Miyagikyo distilleries with a precision that continues to earn the blend its place among the world's most revered pours.

Now, for the first time, it is available in India. The Taketsuru Pure Malt brings together Yoichi's coastal peat and Miyagikyo's softer, fruit-driven character in a marriage that speaks, in equal measure, of tradition and craft. It is a whisky that rewards the unhurried drinker — those willing to sit with it across the change of a glass's temperature, watching the layers shift. Its arrival marks a significant moment for Japanese whisky in India. Not long ago, the category was a curiosity on premium back bars. Today, with educated consumers and an increasingly refined on-trade, Nikka Taketsuru has a natural home here.

**Price:** ₹12,300